



This month's winner is **Ankur Varshney**

He wins **'Use Case Modeling'**

by Kurt Bittner and Ian Spence
Published by Pearson Education (Singapore) Pte Ltd



WIN!

The 'Professional DCOM Application Development' book just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should be shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. e-mail your picture with subject **'Digi Pick'** and postal address to **digipick@thinkdigit.com**. The prize-winning picture will be published each month.

DATA IN THE WRONG HANDS

Most eBay HDDs Contain Sensitive Stuff

We reported earlier in this space that a hard disk containing sensitive data belonging to the German police had been sold on eBay for ₹20 (Rs 1,100). And now, from a survey carried out by the O&O company based in Berlin, called *Data, Data everywhere*, it turns out that of the 200 second-hand hard disks bought on eBay

and scanned for stored information, over 70 per cent contained personal, or accurate and detailed, business data.

In some of the cases, the discovered data was very highly sensitive, seriously jeopardising the security and budget of the hard disks' previous owners. The Berlin-based company also announced by means of this study the methods used to recover the data stored on these hard drives, which are legal and available for interested parties. Using the O&O UnErase and O&O DiskRecovery applications, the data was quite easy to be tracked in the case of over 70 per cent of the cases tested.

It's terrific: of the 3.3 millions files discovered, the specialists from O&O in the course of the survey managed to recover almost 40,000 files generated by Microsoft Word, 15,000 Excel files and the contents of approximately 50 e-mail accounts. The best part is, all the information was found in the same shape as used by their former owners.

This is an area of serious concern, and experts list a variety of ways using

which data should be erased from a hard disk that's about to be chucked. These vary from the straightforward, like formatting the disk several times over, to the extreme, like physically burning it.

YOU'RE NOT ALONE

E-mail Addiction, A Phenomenon

If you check your e-mail several times a day, including when you don't really expect new mail, and even feel silly about it, you're not alone! It turns out that e-mail 'addiction' is a pretty common phenomenon.

The Opinion Research Corporation conducted a methodical study to find out more about this. The study, sponsored by AOL, was conducted on about 4,000 adults in the 20 largest cities in the United States, and revealed several interesting facts.

Forty-one per cent of respondents start the day by checking their e-mail—

People Who Changed Computing

Programming Paradigm Pioneer

Bjarne Stroustrup is to programming what Steve Jobs is to desktop computing. He is credited for making programming

more logical, rational and powerful. Stroustrup is the inventor of the C++



B Stroustrup

programming language, widely regarded as the most powerful programming platform.

With C++ as his tool, Stroustrup revolutionised the use of object-oriented and generic programming techniques in application areas where efficiency is of the essence.

Apart from implementing the object-oriented paradigm in programming, he has made significant contributions to distributed systems, design, programming techniques and software development tools.

Stroustrup has shared his ideas about C++ widely. His book, *The C++ Programming Language*, is one of the most widely-read books of its kind, and has been translated into at least 18 languages. The book has achieved cult status in colleges worldwide. He later released a book, *The Design And Evolution Of C++*, which offered new insights into the description of the way a programming language was shaped by ideas, problems, ideals and constraints.



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